INKRESSION Prologue: Milly Sommerville

Written by

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1 INT. TATTOO SHOP - AFTERNOON **1**

In a flashback to a casual day at The Blindfolded, the tattoo shop where Milly works at, she prepares for the tattoo that her client and friend, Blake, is going to get. While Milly sets up, Blake tells her about an unpleasant encounter he has just had.

MILLY
(casual, not paying attention)
And what did you do?

BLAKE
What am I supposed to do? Fight him?

BLAKE
(agitated)
For real though--why is everyone putting up with this dude acting like he owns the block?

MILLY
(Mocking, friendly)
And you wanted to invite him into your band??

BLAKE
That's different. We've had worse.

MILLY
There--how does that look?

BLAKE
Sick. I like it.

MILLY
Cool. Go ahead and lie down.

MILLY
Now that you're getting this piece-
(pause)
--I'm assuming you finally got everyone you wanted?

BLAKE
More or less, yeah.

MILLY
Alright then, you ready?

BLAKE
Let's do it.

MILLY
Here we go.

Milly is working on the tattoo for Blake, while Blake initiates casual chats with her. Milly responds mostly without her full attention on the conversation, but on doing the tattoo.

BLAKE
Gotta ask--how'd you feel about Gloria getting onto the community board?

MILLY
Fine with me.

MILLY (CONT'D)
Seems like a hardworking lady, she's done a lot for Nortown too. Why?

BLAKE
I don't know. Wasn't there rumor that she immigrated illegally or something?

MILLY
And?

MILLY (CONT'D)
Not like she did anything wrong to us, right?

SOME TIME HAS PASSED SINCE DOING THE TATTOO.

BLAKE
(remembering)
Oh right--did your sister end up choosing a harmonica?

MILLY
(confused)
Huh?

BLAKE
She didn't tell you?

BLAKE (CONT'D)
Molly texted me a few days ago asking if I could recommend her any good brands.

MILLY
(skeptical)

Wait--Molly?? Harmonica???

MILLY
No way.

BLAKE
Your sister is in college, Mil. Maybe she wants to pick up some new hobbies.

SOME TIME HAS PASSED SINCE DOING THE TATTOO.

BLAKE
Check this one out though--

BLAKE (CONT'D)
(reading)
"*Car crashes into Seaside construction site at 100 miles per hour.*"

BLAKE (CONT'D)
(reading)
"Driver pronounced dead on scene. One pedestrian severely injured."

MILLY
Today's news?

BLAKE
Yeah. Nortown Daily.

BLAKE (CONT'D)
(reading)
"Evidence of another passenger found after inspection of the site."

BLAKE (CONT'D)
(reading)
"Police is actively investigating to identify and locate the passenger."

BLAKE
Huh. Passenger dude sounds hella sus, don't you think?

MILLY
Did they give a description of the driver?

BLAKE
Lemme see...(pause)

(reading)
"Male, early 20s."

BLAKE (CONT'D)
If you ask me... sounds like another one of them college kids' fuckups.

Milly finishes the tattoo for Blake and gets up from her chair. Blake also gets up from the tattoo bed.

MILLY
Alright--take a look.

BLAKE
Damnnn Milly! It looks great!

BLAKE (CONT'D)
Not gonna lie though--I wasn't sure if you'd be able to do that faded look, y'know?

MILLY
Dude, for real?

BLAKE
Just messing with you, haha.

MILLY
(sighs)
You play too much.

MILLY
Anyways, same drill. Leave the wrap on for three days, use vaseline--

BLAKE
(dismissing)
Yeah yeah, I got it.

MILLY
Alright then. Time to take my smoke break.

MILLY (CONT'D)
I'll catch you later, Blake.

If Milly chooses to talk to Blake again:

BLAKE
What time is Miyoshiya's after hours today?

MILLY

11 PM. You going?

BLAKE
Yeah, gonna bring a friend along too.

MILLY
Aki added a new drink on the menu.

BLAKE
What is it?

MILLY
He didn't tell me. Said it'd ruin the fun.

BLAKE
Typical Aki, huh?

2 INT. TATTOO SHOP - DAY 2

Milly leaves her work station and walks to the center of the tattoo shop, where her boss, Mr. Z, the owner of The Blindfolded, is busy on his iPad.

Z
All done?

MILLY
Got two more later. You?

Z
I need to make a run in a bit to get some supplies.

Z
But that idea you told me about earlier--
(pause)

Z (CONT'D)
I think it's great.

MILLY
(excited)
THANK YOU!

Z
Do you have a rough idea of which people you want to start designing for?

MILLY

Got a list of people in my sketchbook.

MILLY
But c'mon--the last thing Nortown is missing out on are interesting people, right?

Z
(subtly concerned and unsure)
And when you're done with these designs...do you expect these people to actually get them...?

MILLY
They might not even get to see them.

MILLY (CONT'D)
Cause that was never the point in the first place, Z.

Z
Got it.

Z (CONT'D)
Well-- make sure you at least show me, okay?

MILLY
(laughs)
Yessir.

If Milly chooses to talk to Z again:

MILLY
(remembering)
Also--isn't Tatsu back from New York already?

Z
Yeah, but she's not coming in until Tuesday.

Z (CONT'D)
That trip totally wore her out. Apparently she was booked for the entire week when she was there.

MILLY
(subtly joking, tempting)
You know--I think I should go with her next time.

Z
Oh yeah? So you'd have more days off when you're back?

MILLY
You said it. Not me.

Z
(jokingly criticizing)
Girl, are you trying to put our shop out of business?

In the waiting area, Milly notices several people waiting. She recognizes one of them as Frank, the guy who runs a grocery store with his older brother downstairs to The Blindfolded.

MILLY
(confused)
Frank?

FRANK
(joyful)
Milly!

MILLY
Never thought I'd see you up here. You dropping something off?

FRANK
Yeah. My brother asked me to help bring the sodas up for you guys.

FRANK (CONT'D)
But actually, I've been thinking about getting a tattoo so... thought I'd take a look.

MILLY
Nice! Do you have anything in mind?

FRANK
I was thinking about something like a tattoo of cardboard boxes.

FRANK (CONT'D)
Like the ones we leave outside our shop, y'know?

OPTION A: [Encourage him.]

MILLY
Hmm. Sounds pretty unique.

MILLY (CONT'D)
We can always get it done for you during our after hours, but just make sure that's what you wanna go with.

MILLY (CONT'D)
After all the first tat is pretty important.

FRANK
Yeah, I'll run it through with my brother and see what he thinks.

MILLY
Just let me know when you decide, okay?

FRANK
You got it! Thanks Milly.

OPTION B: [Confused]

MILLY
(subtly confused)
Huh?

FRANK
Yeah... I know it isn't as cool--

MILLY
No, no, not at all! It's just uhh...
(hesitating)
does your brother know about this?

FRANK
Well you know how he is, I can't tell him just yet.

MILLY
Just take some time to think it over. It's probably better if you let him know first.

MILLY
But hey, thanks for bringing up the sodas.

FRANK
You got it!

Milly walks up to a guy sitting on the couch in the waiting area.

MILLY
(subtly enthusiastic)
Hey! Are you here for an appointment?

GUEST
Yeah. I have a 3 PM with Milly Sommerville.

MILLY
(checking her agenda)
So... Lucas, right?

GUEST
Yeah.

MILLY
(showing stencil to GUEST)
Just confirming--this is the design you requested, yes?

GUEST
Correct.

MILLY
Cool! I'll take a quick 5 then we can get started.

GUEST
Thank you.

Milly approaches the girl sitting on the other couch in the corner.

APRIL
You must be Milly. It's nice to finally meet you.

APRIL (CONT'D)
Blake has told me a lot about you.

MILLY
Nothing bad I hope.

MILL (CONT'D)
Are you just visiting town with him?

APRIL
Yeah. He's trying to convince me to move here, join his band, be hip, all of that.

MILLY

And? Are you gonna do it?

APRIL
It's definitely a cool place. But like... (suspicious) salmon apple sandwiches? I'm not sure if I could do that.

MILLY
I'm telling you--you've GOT to try it out.

MILLY (CONT'D)
Trust me. When I first moved here, I thought it sounded crazy too. But once I finally tried it--

MILLY (CONT'D)
It became one of the best sandwiches I've ever had.

APRIL
(laughing)
Alright then. I'll trust you on that one.

APRIL
But hey--if I do move here, could I hit you up for tattoos?

MILLY
Please do! We have our boss Mr.Z back there and another suuuper cool artist Tatsu.
(pause)
She's not here today though.

MILLY
But wait, I don't think I've caught your name yet?

APRIL
I'm April.

MILLY
Nice to meet you, April.

Z calls for Milly before she enters her office.

Z
And Milly--

MILLY
Yeah?

Z
As much as I'm proud of you--

Z (CONT'D)
Don't smoke in your office.

MILLY
(dismissive)
Yeah, yeah--

MILLY (CONT'D)
(whispering to self)
I won't.

3 INT. MILLY'S OFFICE - DAY 3

Milly enters her office and opens the window, where she gets access to the view on the street. She notices pedestrians on the street, as well as Aki, her best friend and an izakaya owner, standing outside by his bicycle.

Milly first clears her heads on things she needs to do.

MILLY
Let's see...two more appointments left...

MILLY
Molly is coming over for the weekend...

MILLY
Gotta help Z pick up the new sculptures on Monday...

MILLY
Mhmm... really gotta find a time to work on the collection.

As Milly thinks about her plan, Aki notices her by the window and walks over.

IF MILLY CHOOSES TO SMOKE BY THE WINDOW:

AKI
(semi-yelling from a distance, downstairs below the window)
I thought Mr. Z banned you from smoking in your office?

MILLY
(unsettled)
Shhhhhhh!

MILLY (CONT'D)
(semi-yelling, suppressing voice from the window)
Dude you are really trying to make me get fired, aren't you?!

AKI
Well, just making sure a friend knows what she is doing.

IF MILLY CHOOSES NOT TO SMOKE BY THE WINDOW:

AKI
(semi-yelling from a distance, downstairs below the window)
Weird to see you popping out there without a smoke.

MILLY
Not tryna get myself fired.

MILLY
You though--should you be chilling out here when you got that line at your restaurant?

AKI
Heading back right now. I was getting my bicycle fixed.

MILLY
(subtly begging)
Are you really not gonna tell me what that new drink is?

AKI
Have some patience, Mil. Just a couple hours left.

MILLY
Ugh. Fine.

AKI
Promise me you won't get too drunk tonight, okay?

MILLY
(dismissive)
Alright, alright.

Just as Milly is about to head back inside for her next appointment, she gets a call from her mother. She answers.

MILLY

Hey mom, what's up?

MOM
...

MILLY
Mom? Are you there?

MOM
(over the phone)
Mil, you gotta come home as soon as you can.

MILLY
(confused)
Huh? Why?

MOM
(unease, worried, confused, nervous, over the phone)
Something happened... your sister, she...

MILLY
(becoming worried and confused)
What? What happened? Is Molly alright?

MOM
(over the phone, still worried)
She's... fine. She's with us right now but... you gotta come and... talk to her.

MILLY
But I thought...she was coming to Nortown later...?

MOM
(pause)
There was a...car accident in Seaside last night.

MILLY
Wait... my friend was just telling me about a car accident...

MOM
Molly was there.

MOM (CONT'D)
She was in that car.

Milly's view begins fading to dark, as the flashback ends and her mind is brough back to the present time.